



GOLF RULES EDUCATION



HOW TO TALK TO THE AI RULES ASSISTANT

Understanding the AI Agent's Limitations

This assistant is powered by a Large Language Model (LLM). While it knows the R&A Rules of Golf perfectly, it has two major technical habits you need to know:

1. **It tries to be too helpful, too fast:** The AI Agent wants to give you an immediate answer. If you dump a massive story on it all at once, it may rush to a conclusion and focus on the wrong penalty.
2. **It struggles to unpack complex timelines:** The AI Agent reads everything at the exact same time. If multiple things happen in a single hole, it can struggle to sort out what happened first and can get easily confused by complicated stories. You can still try it but if you think it's going down the wrong path stop the AI Agent and simplify your questions.
3. **The Agent will assume things if you are not precise with the question:** If you ask a question you must differentiate between 'Stroke Play' and 'Match Play' because rules and penalties can differ. If you are not explicit the AI Agent will assume 'General Play'.

How to Break Down Complex Questions

To get a perfect answer, **do not** tell the AI a long story using "Player A" or "Player B". Instead, pretend **you** are the player, and break the events down step-by-step.

Trap Scenario 1: The Match Play Score Mix-up

- **Don't say:** *"In a match, Player B scores a 5 but tells Player A they got a 4. Player A picks up their ball without marking it. Then Player B corrects the mistake. What is the ruling?"* (The AI can get confused by the timeline and may try to penalize Player A for lifting the ball).
- **Do say:** *"I am in a match. My opponent told me they scored a 4, so I picked up my ball. Then they corrected themselves and said they actually scored a 5. Is there a penalty?"*

Trap Scenario 2: Moving Multiple Things in a Hazard

- **Don't say:** *"Player A's ball is in a penalty area. While walking to it, they step on a loose impediment, accidentally kick their ball, and then remove a branch before hitting. What's the total penalty?"* (The AI may panic, add up too many penalties, or miss the sequence).
- **Do say:** *"My ball is in a red penalty area. I accidentally kicked my ball while walking to it. What should I do?"* (Wait for the AI to answer, then say): *"Okay, now can I move a loose impediment next to it before I hit?"*

How to Stop the Agent Mid-Speech

Because the AI is designed to be highly helpful, it will occasionally launch into a long explanation of a ruling. If you hear it start down the wrong path, **do not wait for it to finish speaking**.



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You can interrupt and instantly cut off the AI by saying these sharp, repetitive commands directly into your microphone:

- 🗣️ "Stop, stop, stop!"
- 🗣️ "Wait, wait, wait!"

Saying these word three (or more) times quickly triggers the agent's interruption filters, completely clears its speech buffer, and opens the microphone back up so you can redirect its logic or supply a specific rule number.

🗣️ How to Force the Agent to Review a Wrong Answer

If the AI gives you a ruling that you know is wrong, do not argue with it or repeat the same story. Repeating the story will just cause the AI to repeat its mistake.

Instead, use your interruption words ("**Wait, wait, wait!**"), break its loop, and force it to audit itself by **feeding it a specific rule snippet or keyword**.

If you want the AI to correct itself on the spot, say these exact phrases:

- 🗣️ "Stop, stop, stop. Please review that under **Rule 3.2d** regarding giving wrong score information in match play."
- 🗣️ "Wait, look at the **Rule Violation Hierarchy**. Does the first infraction cancel out the second player error?"
- 🗣️ "Please look at **Rule 14.1**. I only lifted my ball because of the information my opponent gave me."
- 🗣️ "Re-evaluate that as a **standalone event**. Forget what I said a moment ago and look strictly at the cause of the action."

By naming a specific Rule number or using the phrase "**Review under Rule [X]**", you trigger the AI's internal logic gates, forcing it to drop its assumptions and look directly at its uploaded R&A data.

For the Technically Minded

Why This Agent is More Accurate Than “On-Line” Searching

The AI Agent has been given the latest golf Definitions, Local Rules, Rules and their Clarifications.

Why the AI Agents Dataset Beats General "On-Line" Searching

- **Immunity to Hallucinated Precedents:** The R&A and USGA update rules and issue official clarifications quarterly (typically January, April, July, and October). A general online search can mistakenly crawl historical rule variations (like old 2019 text or archived forums). Your local dataset ensures the agent relies exclusively on current governing principles.
- **Protection Against Forum Myths:** Golf rules are heavily debated online. Public threads often feature confident but incorrect interpretations. A wide-open online search engine might pull an



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answer from a conversational forum post rather than the definitive rulebook. Your AI Agent's vector database acts as a hard filter against this outside noise.

- **Precision Under Strict Logic Frameworks:** Subtle variations in phrasing matter immensely in golf (e.g., the exact distinction between *Rule 16.1 a* denying relief if a tree blocks a stroke versus general abnormal course conditions). By embedding specific chunk limitations and a 0.65 similarity threshold, you force GPT-5.1 to reason using only pure, validated raw rules text rather than filling in semantic gaps.

The True Baseline: How to Match "Online" Capabilities Offline

To completely match the precision of an un-restricted model without risking hallucinations, the AI agent's database must fully account for the **2026 Rules Modernisation and Official Clarification updates**. The AI Agent is expected to perform flawlessly as its local vector chunks explicitly feature the latest core revisions:

- **Unknowingly Moved Balls:** The penalty for a ball that accidentally moves outside the putting green without the player's knowledge has dropped from two strokes to one stroke.
- **Other Players' Pitch Marks:** The updated *Model Local Rule F-2.3* allows free relief from an unrepaired pitch mark in areas cut to fairway height or lower, even if that pitch mark was created by a different player's stroke.
- **Scorecard Length Preferred Lies:** Adjustments to preferred lies in adverse conditions now restrict the lifting, cleaning, and placing relief area to exactly one scorecard length rather than a full club length.
- **Internal Out-of-Bounds:** New boundaries stipulate that internal white stakes defining out-of-bounds on doglegs or adjacent holes apply exclusively to tee shots, vanishing for any subsequent recovery shots.

You should use the Agent sparingly as detailed question sessions cost ten pence a minute. If a club has 1,000 members and everyone decides to call, a hundred pounds can be incurred easily.